



VIOLA PICA

Interior and Architectural Designer

I am pursuing a Master's Degree in Interior Design and have a Bachelor's degree in Interior Design and Environmental Architecture, with a passion for an interdisciplinary approach to architecture. I have a fascination with architecture that expresses itself as a human extension that moulds the overall visitor/client experience.

My experience in design studio East JR has allowed me to engage in different aspects of the industry, from concept development to final design. I love collaborating with creative minds; I have strong problem-solving skills and scrupulous attention to design and construction details. I'm skilled in leading design software, but I also love the tactile nature of freehand drawing and model-making.

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[violapica](#)

London

Interests

- Hand drawing/painting
- Neuropsychology
- Sports (acrobatic gymnastics, rock climbing)
- Photography
- Videography and editing
- Glassblowing

Languages

- Italian - native
- English - native
- Spanish - fluent

References

Edwin Ryder

Founder and Creative Director
at East JR

Email: Edwin@eastjr.co.uk

Steve Jensen

Masters Course Lead

Email: steve.jensen@rca.ac.uk

Work Experience

May
2024

March
2026

Design and Studio Assistant

East JR, Bethnal Green, London

- Client Engagement & Concept Development – Participate in the early stages of design proposals, assisting with client meetings and presentations.
- Technical Drawings & MEP Coordination – Produce plumbing, electrical, and ventilation (MEP) technical drawings and detailed joinery documentation.
- 3D Modeling & Visualization – Develop 3D models for bespoke joinery and interior design projects along design packages.
- Project Coordination & Administration – Organize material samples, manage supplier communications, and assist with project documentation.
- Signage & Branding Design
- Photography, Videography & Marketing – Conduct professional project photoshoots, create content, and manage website updates.

2023
-

2025

Architectural Designer - Freelance Collaboration

Sulla Strada ONLUS - Guatemala & Italy

- Created technical orthographic drawings and visualizations for a 250 sqm multifunctional facility in Cerro La Granadilla, Guatemala.
- Developed architectural plans for presentation to potential financiers, successfully securing funding for the project.
- Worked closely with engineers and field professionals, ensuring feasibility and alignment with local construction methods.
- Explored sustainable and cost-effective architecture, integrating permaculture principles and agroecological land use into the design.
- Project Impact: Approved for construction in 2023; site development is now underway.
- Upcoming Work (2024): Tasked with designing a new Instituto Tecnológico, a vocational training center, funded by a €1M+ donor contribution.
- Preparing orthographic drawings and 3D visualizations for the institution's planning and development.

June
2022 -
August
2022

RIBA Future Architecture Mentoring Scheme

APE Architects

- Participated in construction site visits and analyzed completed projects for real-world architectural insights.
- Gained hands-on experience in project management and architectural workflows.

Skills

Design Software

- Adobe Creative Suite
 - InDesign
 - Illustrator
 - Photoshop
 - Lightroom
- Rhino 3D
- AutoCAD
- Sketchup
- Revit

Technical Skills

- 3D rendering
- Model making
- Concept sketching
- Orthographic drawings
- Architectural detailing
- Retail signage & Environmental Graphics
- MEP Technical Drawings

Soft Skills

- Project coordinating
- Problem solving
- Team collaboration
- Sample and material management
- Client management and communication
- Website maintenance
- Time management
- Knowledge of planning and building regulations

Other Skills

- Furniture and bespoke joinery knowledge
- Photography
- Videography
- Editing

July -
August
2023

Mountain Refuge Staff Member

Vincenzo Sebastiani Refuge, Monte Velino, Abruzzo (2102m ASL)

- Managed accommodation and facility maintenance in a high altitude environment, adapted to harsh conditions requiring resilience. Educated guests on sustainability and environmental impact of responsible tourism.

Education

2025
-
2026

Royal College of Art - Masters in Interior Design

MA Interior Design

- Current thesis project proposes the adaptive reuse of a redundant corporate tower in Canary Wharf, inserting spaces for artists, makers and the public into an existing structure through salvaged and repurposed materials. Delving into and specialising in reuse, sustainable practice, and the psychology behind spaces.

2020
-
2023

Ravensbourne University London - ARB Part 1

BA (Hons) Interior Design and Environmental Architecture

- Specialised in refurbishments, renovations, sustainability, and interior solutions. Developed skills in 3D modeling, technical drawing, and environmental architecture.
- RIBA Part 1 Certified.

Awards, Recognitions & Industry Engagement

2024

RIBA SELA End-of-Year Show Judge

Invited by RIBA South East London Architects Group to evaluate student projects at Ravensbourne University's end-of-year architecture showcase, offering feedback and industry insights.

2024

Present

Active Member – RIBA SELA Architects Network

Currently engaging in monthly discussions with RIBA SELA members on industry topics, London architectural developments, professional opportunities, elections. Participated in networking events with key figures in the London design industry.

October
2023

RIBA First Prize Winner

RIBA First Prize Winner student for best Final Major Project of the third and last year of our Bachelors Degree. Awarded by South East London Architects Group

July
2023

Shortlisted for the "Craft Excellence" Recognition Awards

Interior Educator (IE) Summer Show

My final major project has been selected to be presented at the IE Summer Show, held at the OXO Barge House, South Bank, London.

July
2023

Selection of my project for publication on Dezeen

My project has been published in one of the most important architecture, interior and design magazines in the world: Dezeen.